KIEU STUDIO · GITHUB RADAR · EPISODE 11 · CHEAT SHEET

thinkrail

JetBrains' IDE for coding agents that learns your project.

github.com/JetBrains/thinkrail

+5,738	6,877	Apache-2.0
stars in 7 days · ≈ 820 stars/day · Trending lists no 30-day figure	total stars · GitHub API	license · created Jul 8, 2026

ThinkRail is an open-source IDE (a JetBrains incubator project) built around the pi coding agent: separate git worktree workspaces, editor, diffs, terminal, specs as project memory, skills and MCP. There is a desktop app and a CLI that opens in the browser.

How it works in six steps

1. **Open a git repo** — as the project
2. **Create workspaces** — one git worktree each
3. **Chat with the pi agent** — parallel sessions
4. **Specs** — SPEC.md is project memory
5. **Review the diff** — comment inside the IDE
6. **Open and merge the PR** — watch CI, review, merge

Quick start

```
# Install the CLI (macOS / Linux)
curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/JetBrains/
thinkrail/main/install.sh | bash

# Open a repo as a project
thinkrail ~/code/my-repo

# Desktop app
Download thinkrail-desktop-* from the Releases page

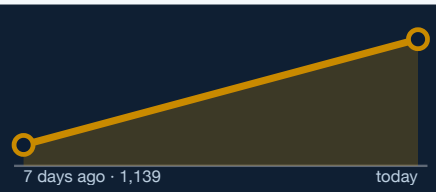
# Turn off extra data sharing
thinkrail --no-analytics

# Needs: Git and a model provider (JetBrains AI sign-in or your own key);
macOS 14+, Windows x64 or Linux
```

Key commands / features

- **`thinkrail [repo]`** — open ThinkRail, with a git repo if you like
- **`thinkrail --help`** — list the flags
- **`thinkrail --version`** — print the version
- **`thinkrail update`** — update the CLI
- **`thinkrail uninstall`** — uninstall

Growth



Two real points: the start of the window and today, axis from zero. The gain is as reported by GitHub Trending; we did not rebuild the star history.

Why this repo exists

- Agents in a terminal are hard to follow, and several in parallel trample the same folder.
- One workspace per task, diffs and review inside the IDE; SPEC.md keeps project knowledge across sessions.

What to use it for

- Run several agents in parallel on one repo
- Review the diff right before merging
- Keep project knowledge in SPEC.md
- Use existing skills and MCP in one place

Think twice before you use it

- A JetBrains incubator project, version 0.3.0: very new.
- Sends basic usage stats and crash reports (random install ID, no source code, prompts or keys); crash reports are always sent.
- Installed with curl | bash: read the script first. The Linux build is not signed.
- You need your own model provider: cost depends on the provider.

Sources: the repo's README, https://github.com/JetBrains/thinkrail, https://thinkrail.ai. Stars: GitHub API; gains: GitHub Trending (as reported by Trending), snapshot Nov 1, 2026; stars measure attention, not quality: re-check before relying on them. Summarized in Kieu Studio's own words; commands copied from the README; no third-party logos or screenshots.
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